PROBLEM NS11

Couette Flow between Porous Plates

Original statement · NS11.pdf

Couette flow with injection | Pathline | Wall forces and heat fluxes | Integral balances

OFFICIAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

A perfect liquid of constant properties (density ρ, viscosity μ, thermal conductivity k and specific heat c) is confined between two infinite parallel plates at a distance h, as depicted in the figure below. The lower wall is at rest, while the upper one moves parallel to itself with a constant velocity U in the positive x-direction. The working fluid is injected through the lower porous wall into the channel with a uniform velocity v_l in the y-direction, while being removed from the channel through the upper porous plate with a uniform velocity v_u, also in the y-direction.

Gravitational forces can be neglected. The velocity field, $\bar{v} = u\bar{e}_x + v\bar{e}_y$, is assumed steady and independent of the x- and z-coordinates, $\partial/\partial t = \partial/\partial x = \partial/\partial z = 0$. The pressure at the upper wall has a constant value p_u. The lower and upper walls are kept at constant temperatures T_l and T_u, respectively. Known data: $(\rho, \mu, k, c, h, U, v_l, p_u, T_l, T_u)$.

1. (1 point). Obtain the only possible value of v_u consistent with the assumption of x-independence, and find $v(y)$.

2. (2.5 points). Determine the pressure field $p(x, y)$, and the horizontal velocity field, $u(y)$. Express $u(y)$ in terms of the Reynolds number based on the injection velocity, $\mathrm{Re} = \rho v_l h/\mu$.

3. (1 point). Compute the volume flux per unit spanwise length, Q, across a surface perpendicular to the plates (z is the spanwise direction). Particularize for the limit $\mathrm{Re} \ll 1$, and explain the result.

4. (1.5 points). Obtain the trajectory of the fluid particle with initial position $(x, y) = (0, x_0)$ at $t = 0$, and the corresponding pathline. Compute the time t_s at which the particle arrives at the upper wall, and the corresponding position x_s.

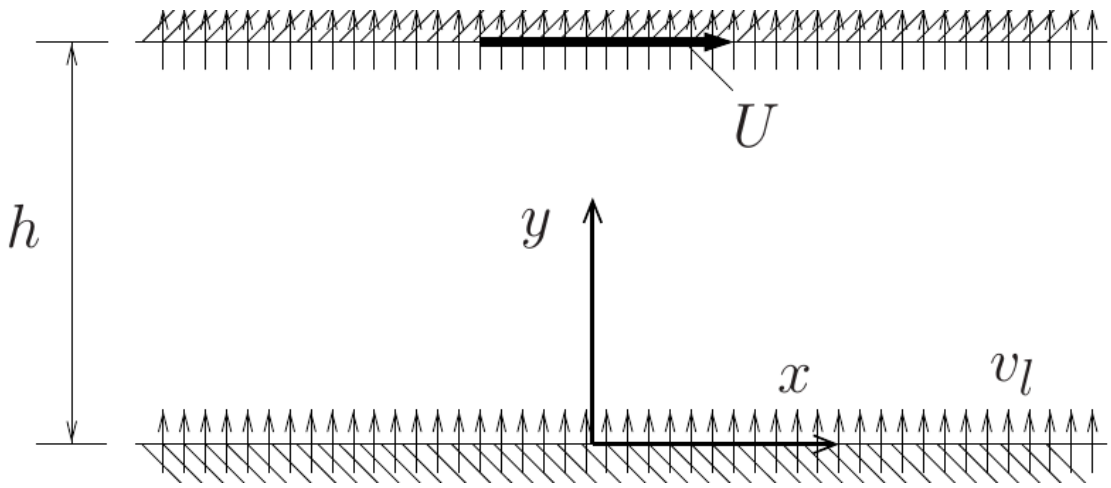
5. (1 point). Compute the viscous force per unit surface that the fluid exerts on the lower and upper walls. Particularize for the limit $\mathrm{Re} \ll 1$, and explain the result.

6. (2 points). Write the differential equation and boundary conditions that determine the temperature field, $T(y)$. Obtain $T(y)$ neglecting the effect of viscous dissipation.

7. (1 point). Compute the conductive heat flux (heat transferred by conduction p.u. surface) from the fluid to each wall.

8. (2 additional points). Using an appropriately defined control volume, perform integral momentum and energy balances, and discuss the results of questions 5 and 7 in the light of these integral balances.

The sheet is headed "INTRODUCTION TO FLUID MECHANICS, Jan 14, 2013, PROBLEM 2 (1 hour)".



Statement figure (crop of NS11.pdf, p. 1): channel of height h between two porous plates, injection velocity v_l through the lower wall at rest, upper wall moving with velocity U, axes x and y

`Source: NS11.pdf (page 1 of 3: statement; pages 2 and 3: handwritten solution). Notes.pdf, Chapter 4: continuity Eq. 4.40, momentum Eq. 4.41, energy Eq. 4.42, internal-energy balance Eq. 4.25, stress components in Cartesian coordinates.`

Worked solution

Hypotheses, Data and Unknowns

- Steady planar flow of a perfect liquid (constant ρ, μ, k, c) between two porous plates, with $\partial/\partial x = \partial/\partial z = \partial/\partial t = 0$ for the velocity. Gravity neglected; no chemical reaction and no radiation.
- The lower wall ($y = 0$) is at rest at T_l and injects the liquid with the uniform normal velocity $v_l > 0$; the upper wall ($y = h$) moves with $U\bar{e}_x$ at T_u and the pressure on it is p_u. The tangential velocity of the liquid equals that of each wall (no-slip).
- Data: $(\rho,\ \mu,\ k,\ c,\ h,\ U,\ v_l,\ p_u,\ T_l,\ T_u)$. Unknowns: $v_u, v(y), p, u(y), Q$, the pathline, the wall forces, $T(y)$ and the wall heat fluxes.
- Dimensionless numbers: $\mathrm{Re} = \rho v_l h/\mu$ and $\mathrm{Pr} = \mu c/k$, so that $\rho c v_l h/k = \mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}$.

Symbol	Meaning	SI unit
h	gap between the plates	m
U	velocity of the upper wall	m/s
v_l, v_u	injection and removal velocities	m/s
p_u	pressure on the upper wall	Pa

Symbol	Meaning	SI unit
T_l, T_u	wall temperatures	K
Re, Pr	injection Reynolds number, Prandtl number	1

Frames, Field Form and Boundary Conditions

- Cartesian frame (x, y, z): x along the plates in the direction of U, y normal to the plates and upward from the lower wall, z spanwise. The basis is orthonormal and right-handed (no change of basis).
- Field form: $\bar{v} = u(y)\,\bar{e}_x + v(y)\,\bar{e}_y, T = T(y), p = p(x, y)$.
- Control volume for item 8: the box $0 < y < h$ and width Δx in x (unit spanwise length); surfaces: the lower wall Σ_l ($\bar{n} = -\bar{e}_y$), the upper wall Σ_u ($\bar{n} = +\bar{e}_y$) and the two faces Σ_1, Σ_2 ($\bar{n} = \mp\bar{e}_x$).

Location	Condition	Origin
$y = 0$	$u = 0, v = v_l, T = T_l$	lower wall at rest, injection
$y = h$	$u = U, v = v_u, T = T_u$	upper wall moving, removal
$y = h$	$p = p_u$	statement

Step-by-Step Derivation

3.1 Continuity: v_u and $v(y)$ (item 1)

$$\underbrace{\cancel{\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}}}_{\partial_x = 0} + \frac{dv}{dy} = 0 \implies v = \text{const} \tag{1}$$

The constant is the injection velocity, $v(0) = v_l$, so $v = v_l$ for every y and the removal velocity must be the same:

$$\boxed{v_u = v_l, \qquad v(y) = v_l} \tag{2}$$

3.2 Pressure and horizontal velocity (item 2)

y-momentum, with $v = v_l$ constant ($dv/dy = 0$) and no gravity:

$$\rho\Big(\underbrace{u\cancel{\frac{\partial v}{\partial x}}}_{\partial_x = 0} + v\,\underbrace{\frac{dv}{dy}}_{=0}\Big) = -\frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \mu\underbrace{\frac{d^2 v}{dy^2}}_{=0} \implies \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} = 0 \implies p = p(x) \tag{3}$$

The pressure on the upper wall is p_u for every x, so p is the constant p_u:

$$\boxed{p(x, y) = p_u \ \text{ for all } x,\ y}, \qquad \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} = 0 \tag{4}$$

x-momentum:

$$\rho\Big(\underbrace{u\cancel{\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}}}_{\partial_x = 0} + v_l\frac{du}{dy}\Big) = -\underbrace{\frac{\partial p}{\partial x}}_{=0} + \mu\frac{d^2 u}{dy^2} \implies \frac{d^2 u}{dy^2} - \frac{\mathrm{Re}}{h}\frac{du}{dy} = 0 \tag{5}$$

since $\rho v_l/\mu = \mathrm{Re}/h$. Trying $u = e^{\lambda y}$ gives $\lambda(\lambda - \mathrm{Re}/h) = 0$, so $u = C_1 + C_2\, e^{\mathrm{Re}\, y/h}$. The conditions $u(0) = 0$ and $u(h) = U$ give $C_1 = -C_2$ and $C_2(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1) = U$:

$$\boxed{u(y) = U\,\frac{e^{\mathrm{Re}\, y/h} - 1}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}} \tag{6}$$

For $\mathrm{Re} \to 0$, the Taylor expansion $e^x = 1 + x + O(x^2)$ gives $u \to U\,\dfrac{\mathrm{Re}\, y/h}{\mathrm{Re}} = U\,\dfrac{y}{h}$: plane Couette flow is recovered.

3.3 Volume flux (item 3)

The flux per unit spanwise length through a section $x = \text{const}$ is $Q = \int_0^h u\,dy$. The antiderivative of $e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y/h} - 1$ is $(h/\mathrm{Re})\,e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y/h} - y$, and Barrow's rule between 0 and h gives $(h/\mathrm{Re})(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1) - h$:

$$\boxed{Q = \frac{U}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}\left[\frac{h}{\mathrm{Re}}\left(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1\right) - h\right] = Uh\left[\frac{1}{\mathrm{Re}} - \frac{1}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}\right]} \tag{7}$$

For $\mathrm{Re} \ll 1$, $e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1 = \mathrm{Re}\left(1 + \mathrm{Re}/2 + \mathrm{Re}^2/6 + \dots\right)$, so $1/(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1) = 1/\mathrm{Re} - 1/2 + \mathrm{Re}/12 + \dots$ and

$$Q \simeq Uh\left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{\mathrm{Re}}{12}\right) \to \frac{Uh}{2} \tag{8}$$

The flux tends to that of plane Couette flow, the mean velocity $U/2$ times the gap: for small injection velocity the transverse flow barely distorts the linear profile.

3.4 Trajectory and pathline (item 4)

A particle moves with the local velocity: $dy/dt = v_l$ and $dx/dt = u(y)$. Let its initial position be (x_i, y_i) at $t = 0$. Then $y = y_i + v_l t$ and, with $dt = dy/v_l$,

$$x - x_i = \int_0^t u\,dt' = \frac{U}{v_l\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\int_{y_i}^{y}\left(e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y'/h} - 1\right)dy' = \frac{U}{v_l\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\left[\frac{h}{\mathrm{Re}}\left(e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y/h} - e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y_i/h}\right) - (y - y_i)\right] \tag{9}$$

which is the pathline $x(y)$; with $y = y_i + v_l t$ it is also the trajectory $x(t)$. The particle reaches the upper wall at $y = h$:

$$t_s = \frac{h - y_i}{v_l}, \qquad x_s = x_i + \frac{U}{v_l\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\left[\frac{h}{\mathrm{Re}}\left(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - e^{\mathrm{Re}\,y_i/h}\right) - (h - y_i)\right] \tag{10}$$

Reading of the initial position

The sheet writes the initial position as $(x, y) = (0, x_0)$; the handwritten solution takes the particle at the lower wall, $(x, y) = (x_0, 0)$. Both follow from (9) and (10): for the printed values $(x_i, y_i) = (0, x_0)$ and for the reading of the key $(x_i, y_i) = (x_0, 0)$, which gives $t_s = h/v_l$.

$$\boxed{x - x_0 = \frac{U}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}\left[\frac{h}{\mathrm{Re}\, v_l}\left(e^{\mathrm{Re}\, v_l t/h} - 1\right) - t\right], \quad t_s = \frac{h}{v_l}, \quad x_s = x_0 + \frac{Uh}{v_l}\left[\frac{1}{\mathrm{Re}} - \frac{1}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}\right]} \qquad (y_i = 0) \tag{11}$$

Note that $x_s - x_0 = Q/v_l$: the particle crosses the channel in the time h/v_l at the mean horizontal velocity Q/h.

3.5 Viscous forces on the walls (item 5)

The normal pointing into the liquid is $+\bar{e}_y$ on the lower wall and $-\bar{e}_y$ on the upper wall; $(-p\bar{\bar{I}} + \bar{\bar{\tau}}') \cdot \bar{n}$ is the force per unit area that the liquid exerts on the wall. The viscous components are $\tau'_{xy} = \mu\, du/dy$ and $\tau'_{yy} = 2\mu\, dv/dy = 0$ (Notes.pdf, stress components, Cartesian coordinates). From (6), $du/dy = \dfrac{U\,\mathrm{Re}}{h}\dfrac{e^{\mathrm{Re}\, y/h}}{e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1}$:

$$\bar{f}_l^{\,\mathrm{visc}} = \bar{\bar{\tau}}' \cdot \bar{e}_y = \mu \frac{du}{dy}\Big|_0 \bar{e}_x = \frac{\mu U\,\mathrm{Re}}{h\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\bar{e}_x, \qquad \bar{f}_u^{\,\mathrm{visc}} = \bar{\bar{\tau}}' \cdot (-\bar{e}_y) = -\mu \frac{du}{dy}\Big|_h \bar{e}_x = -\frac{\mu U\,\mathrm{Re}\, e^{\mathrm{Re}}}{h\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\bar{e}_x \tag{12}$$

$$\boxed{\bar{f}_l = \frac{\mu U\,\mathrm{Re}}{h\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\,\bar{e}_x, \qquad \bar{f}_u = -\frac{\mu U\,\mathrm{Re}\, e^{\mathrm{Re}}}{h\,(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1)}\,\bar{e}_x} \tag{13}$$

For $\mathrm{Re} \ll 1$, $\mathrm{Re}/(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1) \to 1$ and $\mathrm{Re}\, e^{\mathrm{Re}}/(e^{\mathrm{Re}} - 1) \to 1$: $\bar{f}_l \to \dfrac{\mu U}{h}\bar{e}_x$ and $\bar{f}_u \to -\dfrac{\mu U}{h}\bar{e}_x$, the equal and opposite shear forces of plane Couette flow. For $\mathrm{Re} \neq 0$ they are not equal: the lower wall, where the injected liquid has no horizontal velocity, feels less shear than the upper one.

3.6 Temperature (item 6)

The energy equation (4.42) with $v = v_l$ and $\partial_x = 0$, and the boundary conditions, are

$$\rho c\, v_l \frac{dT}{dy} = \mu \left(\frac{du}{dy}\right)^2 + k\frac{d^2T}{dy^2}, \qquad T(0) = T_l, \quad T(h) = T_u \tag{14}$$

where $\phi_v = \mu(du/dy)^2$ is the viscous dissipation. Neglecting it, and dividing by k with $\rho c v_l h/k = \mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}$:

$$\frac{d^2T}{dy^2} - \frac{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}}{h}\frac{dT}{dy} = 0 \implies T = B_1 + B_2\, e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}\, y/h} \tag{15}$$

the same equation as (5) with Re replaced by $\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}$. The conditions $T(0) = T_l$ and $T(h) = T_u$ give $B_1 + B_2 = T_l$ and $B_2(e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}} - 1) = T_u - T_l$:

$$\boxed{\frac{T - T_l}{T_u - T_l} = \frac{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}\, y/h} - 1}{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}} - 1}} \tag{16}$$

3.7 Heat flux to each wall (item 7)

The heat flux from the liquid to a wall is $\bar{q}\cdot\bar{n}$ with $\bar{n}$ pointing out of the liquid and $\bar{q} = -k\nabla T$. From (16), $dT/dy = (T_u - T_l)\dfrac{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}}{h}\dfrac{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}\, y/h}}{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}} - 1}$, and $k\,\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}/h = \rho c v_l$:

$$\boxed{q_u = -k\frac{dT}{dy}\Big|_h = -\rho c v_l\,(T_u - T_l)\,\frac{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}}}{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}} - 1}, \qquad q_l = k\frac{dT}{dy}\Big|_0 = \rho c v_l\,(T_u - T_l)\,\frac{1}{e^{\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}} - 1}} \tag{17}$$

For $\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr} \to 0$, $q_l \to k(T_u - T_l)/h$ and $q_u \to -k(T_u - T_l)/h$: pure conduction between the walls.

3.8 Integral balances (item 8)

Momentum, x component (Notes.pdf, integral momentum balance for the fixed volume, steady):

$$\int_\Sigma \rho\, u\, (\bar v \cdot \bar n)\, d\sigma = -\int_\Sigma p\, n_x\, d\sigma + \int_\Sigma (\bar{\bar\tau}' \cdot \bar n)_x\, d\sigma$$

Surface	$\int \rho u\, \bar v \cdot \bar n\, d\sigma$	$-\int p\, n_x\, d\sigma$	$\int (\bar{\bar\tau}' \cdot \bar n)_x\, d\sigma$
Σ_l	0 ($u = 0$)	0 ($n_x = 0$)	$-\mu\, u'(0)\, \Delta x$
Σ_u	$\rho\, U\, v_l\, \Delta x$	0 ($n_x = 0$)	$+\mu\, u'(h)\, \Delta x$
$\Sigma_1 + \Sigma_2$	cancel	cancel (p uniform)	cancel ($\tau'_{xx} = 0$)

$$\rho\, v_l\, U = \mu \left[\left.\frac{du}{dy}\right|_h - \left.\frac{du}{dy}\right|_0 \right] \tag{18}$$

Using (13), this is $\rho v_l U = -(f_{u,x} + f_{l,x})$: the net horizontal force that the liquid exerts on the two walls is $-\rho v_l U$, because the liquid leaves through the upper wall carrying the horizontal momentum ρU per unit mass, which it does not have when it enters through the lower one, and the walls supply it. Equation (18) holds exactly for every Re (indeed $\mu\, U\, \mathrm{Re}/h = \rho v_l U$) and confirms (13); for $\mathrm{Re} \to 0$ the right-hand side vanishes and the two shear forces cancel.

Internal energy (Notes.pdf, Eq. 4.25, steady, no compression work, dissipation neglected): $\int_\Sigma \rho c\, T\, (\bar v \cdot \bar n)\, d\sigma = -\int_\Sigma \bar q \cdot \bar n\, d\sigma$. The faces Σ_1, Σ_2 cancel and the walls give

$$\rho c\, v_l\, (T_u - T_l)\, \Delta x = -(q_u + q_l)\, \Delta x \implies q_u + q_l = -\rho c\, v_l\, (T_u - T_l) \tag{19}$$

which agrees with (17): the heat conducted into the liquid through the two walls, $-(q_u + q_l) = \rho c v_l (T_u - T_l)$, equals the net internal-energy flux convected across the control volume.

Interpretation, Limits and Dimensional Check

- **Physical meaning.** The injection convects momentum and heat across the channel: for $\mathrm{Re} > 0$ the profiles are exponential, with the velocity gradient concentrated near the upper wall (towards which the liquid is carried), and the thermal profile has the same form with $\mathrm{Re}\,\mathrm{Pr}$.
- **Limits.** For $\mathrm{Re} \to 0$: $u = Uy/h$, $Q = Uh/2$, $\bar{f}_l = -\bar{f}_u = \mu U/h\,\bar{e}_x$ and the temperature is linear (Couette flow with conduction). For $\mathrm{Re} \gg 1$, $u \simeq U\, e^{\mathrm{Re}\,(y-h)/h}$: the horizontal velocity is confined to a layer of thickness h/Re at the upper wall and $Q \simeq Uh/\mathrm{Re} \to 0$, since the injected liquid, which starts at rest, is swept to the upper wall before it can be dragged.
- **Dimensional check.** $\rho v_l h/\mu$ is dimensionless; Uh has units of a flux per unit span, m^2/s; $\mu U\,\mathrm{Re}/h$ is $\mathrm{N/m}^2$; $\rho c v_l\,\Delta T$ is $\mathrm{W/m}^2$.
- **Consistency of the limits.** At $\mathrm{Re} = 0$, (18) gives $0 = 0$ and (19) gives $q_u = -q_l$.